Offline Sales Field Guide

How to walk into a local business, show them what is missing, and get a WhatsApp number.

Name _____ Area _____ Group offer today _____

SEARCH PLAYBOOK
WeMustCreate · Johannesburg

The 3 phases

Phase 1: Look and say hello

- **Check them on Google Maps first.** Stand back and look. Is the business on the map? Is it marked closed? Are the photos old? This is your reason to talk to them.
- **Find the boss.** Ask who makes the decisions. Say: *"Hi, I'm [your name] from [your area]. I almost missed you on the map."*
- **Check the details.** Ask them to confirm the business name and opening hours.

Phase 3: Make the offer

- **Start with their problem.** Show them the gap you found on the map. Offer a short demo, like you would offer a guest a cup of tea.
- **Offer a group deal.** Say: *"Sign up with two other businesses and you get the group offer today."*
- **Explain control.** Say: *"We set up your listing so you are the owner. You decide what it says."*

Phase 2: Get their details

- **Ask for WhatsApp.** Say: *"Can I take your number? I will send you a 30-second demo."*
- **Take a photo.** Ask first. Photograph the shop sign, then send the photo to their WhatsApp straight away.

Lead sheet

Business name	
Decision maker	
WhatsApp	
Gap I found	
Photo sent (Y/N)	

One sheet per business. Write down only what the person agrees to share.

Your 5 steps for every visit

1. **Check first.** Look the business up on Google Maps. Note what is missing.
2. **Say hello.** Find the boss. Open with the map line.
3. **Offer help.** Show the gap. Offer a short demo.
4. **Get the details.** Get the WhatsApp number, take the photo, check the name and hours.
5. **Close with care.** Stay safe. Ask for the sign-up. Be honest about price and what they get.

Tips

- **Keep it short.** 60 to 90 seconds.
- **Talk about benefits.** Say *"more customers"*, not *"more features"*.
- **Sound sure.** Say *"I'll show you in 30 seconds"*, not *"only if you want"*.
- **Use simple words.** No jargon.
- **Check before you leave.** Say the WhatsApp number and business name back to them.

Words you can use

OPENING
"Hi, I'm [your name] from [your area]. I almost missed you on the map. Are your hours and photos up to date?"

ASK FOR WHATSAPP
"Can I take your WhatsApp number? I'll send a 30-second demo."

ASK FOR A PHOTO
"May I take a photo of your sign? I'll show you what we would update."

GROUP DEAL
"Sign up with two other businesses and you get the group offer today."

CONTROL OF THE LISTING
"You will be the owner of your listing. Nothing changes without your OK."

Remember: Be polite and ask permission. No pressure. Never say anything that is not true. Keep a record of every lead.

Set-and-Forget Setup for a Local Business

Collect on site, build once, connect to WhatsApp. Works for any shop or service.

STAGE 1

Collect: photos on site

Do this at the business

1. **The sign.** Photograph the street number and the front of the shop, for example 12 Main Road.
2. **What they use.** Take a close photo of the main tools or machines.
3. **What they sell.** Photograph the shelves or the main stock.
4. **The counter.** Photograph the counter and what is on it.
5. **The team.** Optional. Ask permission first.

Example, a hair salon: the sign, the styling chairs, the products on the shelf and the price list.

Turn location on. Take every photo at the business, so the photo matches the address.

STAGE 2

Build: Google profile and site

Google Business Profile and Google Sites

1. **Start verification.** Ask Google to verify the business profile. Follow the Google Business Profile guide in our Intel Hub.
2. **Add photos.** Upload 3 photos of the outside, 3 of the inside and 5 of what they sell.
3. **Build the site.** Use the business name as the main heading. Add 3 groups of products or services, each with photos.
4. **Add a WhatsApp button.** Use a link that starts a WhatsApp chat, so you can see who enquires.

Example groups, a hair salon: cuts, colour, treatments.

STAGE 3

Connect: WhatsApp orders

Catalogue, link and test

1. **Make the catalogue.** In the WhatsApp Business app, add the products with the photos you took. Turn the cart on.
2. **Make the link.** Use this pattern, with the business number in international format and no plus sign:

   `wa.me/27XXXXXXXXX?text=Order%20[item]`
3. **Test it.** Place a test order at the business. Check the message arrives.
4. **Join it up.** Put the website link on the Google profile's Website button.

REMEMBER: verify on site. The client owns their profile, their site and their catalogue.